

Element Dynasty

Chapter 1 The Insepto

Akansh floated in the endless darkness of space.

Tiny stars sparkled far away, but there was nothing around him except silence. He opened his eyes suddenly. "Not again..."

he thought. He tried to scream, but no sound came out. He tried again and again.

Nothing. Panic filled his chest. Then a tiny black dot appeared before him. It was darker than the darkness itself. Akansh slowly reached out and touched it with his right hand.

BOOM.

The dot expanded across the universe. Stars vanished one by one until only darkness remained. Then a deep voice echoed from everywhere and nowhere.

"This is my home, insect."

The darkness rushed toward him, flowing into his body through his right hand.

Akansh woke up with a gasp, clutching that same hand to his chest.

His heart was still racing as he looked around the room. The familiar sight of his ceiling fan spinning slowly above him brought him back to reality. While the faint morning sunlight slipped through the curtains and spread across the room. Akansh sat silently on his bed for a few moments, trying to calm his breathing. His mind was still trapped in the dream, the endless darkness, the vanishing stars, and that voice. Especially that voice.

"Why do I keep seeing this dream?" he whispered to himself.

Without thinking, he glanced down at his right hand, the same hand that had touched the darkness in his dream. For a moment, he simply stared at it before shaking his head and letting out a small sigh.

"Just a dream," he muttered.

He reached for his phone lying beside his pillow and checked the time.

8:30 AM. Sunday. A small smile appeared on his face. He pulled his blanket over himself and turned to the other side of the bed, ready to continue his interrupted sleep.

Before he could close his eyes, his mother's voice echoed through the house.

"Akansh! Wake up! If you're sleeping this late on a Sunday, at least help your dad!"

Akansh groaned and buried his face deeper into the pillow.

"Mom, please... It's Sunday. I want to sleep."

"I know it's Sunday," his mother replied immediately. "That's exactly why it's housework day. Come downstairs, have your breakfast, and help your father clean the storeroom."

Akansh let out a defeated sigh.

"Fine... I'm coming."

A few minutes later, after freshening up and finishing his breakfast, Akansh followed his father towards the old storeroom. The moment he stepped inside, he regretted it immediately. Dust covered almost everything. Old newspapers were piled up in one corner while broken toys from his childhood lay forgotten beneath a wooden shelf. Rusty tools, old boxes, and objects nobody remembered owning anymore filled every part of the room. It felt less like a storeroom and more like a place where old memories had been abandoned.

As Akansh moved an old blanket aside, something caught his eye.

A small rusty box. He frowned and picked it up carefully. The metal felt cold in his hands despite the warm morning air. He brushed away the thick layer of dust covering its surface and examined it closely. The box had no lock. No keyhole. No markings. Nothing. It was simply a silent, black box resting in his hands. Akansh frowned once more.

"I've never seen this before."

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Akansh turned the box over in his hands once more, carefully examining every side. The symbols carved into its surface were unlike anything he had ever seen before. They were not English, Hindi, or any language he recognized. Some looked like circles surrounded by red lines, while others resembled stars connected by strange patterns. "Maybe it's just some old antique thing," he said to himself. Curiosity quickly got the better of him. He pulled at the lid. Nothing happened. He tried pushing it instead. Still nothing. He pressed against the sides, searched for a hidden button, and even shook it lightly near his ear. Nothing. The box remained completely silent. "Seriously?" Akansh muttered. "What kind of box doesn't even have a lock?"

After several more failed attempts, frustration began replacing curiosity. Just then, his father walked into the storeroom carrying another old cardboard box. "Found something interesting?" he asked. Akansh held up the rusty box. "Dad, whose box is this? I've never seen it before."

His father looked at it for a moment before placing the cardboard box down beside him. "Oh, that thing. You don't know about it?" His father nodded. "Your grandfather found it many years ago while working in the fields. He brought it home thinking there might be something valuable inside." Akansh looked down at the box again. "So what was inside?" His father laughed softly. "That's the funny part. Nobody knows." Akansh raised an eyebrow. "What do you mean nobody knows?"

"We tried opening it dozens of times," his father replied. "Your grandfather tried. I tried. Even your uncle tried once using a screwdriver and a hammer." Akansh looked at the box in surprise. "And?"

"And nothing. It never opened." His father shrugged. "Eventually we gave up and threw it into the storeroom along with everything else." For a few moments, Akansh simply stared at the box resting quietly in his hands. No lock. No keyhole. No way to open it. Yet somehow, he couldn't shake the strange feeling that the box wanted him to keep trying. Almost as if... it was waiting for someone. Akansh looked down at the box once again. The strange symbols carved into its surface seemed almost alive under the thin layer of dust.

"Dad," he said after a moment of silence, "can I keep it?" His father looked at him in surprise. "The box?" Akansh nodded. "Yeah. I don't know why, but it feels interesting. Maybe I'll figure out how to open it someday." His father chuckled. "If you can open it, you'll succeed where your grandfather, your uncle, and I all failed." Akansh smiled slightly. "Challenge accepted."

His father laughed and shook his head. "Fine, keep it if you want. It's been sitting here doing nothing for years anyway." "Thanks, Dad." Carefully holding the box in both hands, Akansh walked out of the storeroom and headed upstairs to his room. As he climbed the stairs, he glanced down at the strange symbols once more. For some reason, he couldn't explain it, but the box no longer felt like an old forgotten object from the storeroom. It felt important. For him.

Akansh entered his room and gently placed the box on his study table beside his books and phone. The morning sunlight from the window fell directly onto its surface, making the strange Red symbols shine faintly for a brief moment. Akansh blinked. The glow disappeared. "...Probably just the sunlight,"

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He pulled a chair closer and sat down in front of it. For a few moments, he simply stared at it in silence. The layer of dust covering it reminded him just how long it must have been lying forgotten in the storeroom. He picked up a napkin from his desk and slowly wiped the dust away from its surface. As the dust disappeared, strange red lines carved into circular patterns began to reveal themselves. The markings spread across the box in perfect symmetry, connecting to one another like a puzzle or a map. Under the faint sunlight entering through the window, the symbols almost seemed alive. Akansh frowned.

He had never seen anything like them before.

"What exactly are you?" he whispered.

He picked the box up and turned it over in his hands.

There was no lock. No keyhole. No hinges. Not even a visible opening.

It looked less like a box and more like a solid block of metal that had somehow decided to pretend otherwise.

"How does something like this even work?" he muttered.

Curiosity quickly turned into determination. He pressed one of the symbols with his thumb. Nothing happened. He pressed another. Still nothing. One by one he tried every symbol he could find. Nothing. Akansh frowned and pulled at what looked like the lid. It didn't move even a millimetre. He tried twisting it. Still nothing. He held it close to his ear and shook it gently, hoping to hear something moving inside. Silence. Not even the slightest sound came from within. "Great," he sighed.

"An indestructible metal cube."

Determined not to lose a battle against an old piece of metal, he tried again.

He pushed it. Pulled it. Pressed every symbol once more. He even searched carefully around its edges for a hidden switch or button. Nothing. His eyes suddenly landed on the toolbox near his desk. A few moments later, he returned holding a hammer. "Alright," he said confidently.

"Let's see how strong you really are."

He tapped the box. The hammer vibrated in his hand. The box didn't even get a scratch.

Akansh stared at it. The hammer looked more damaged than the box.

"Okay... that's unfair."

After several more minutes of failed attempts, he finally leaned back in his chair with a sigh of defeat. "Fine," he said.

"You win."

He dropped the box onto the table and reached for his phone. Almost immediately, a notification appeared on the screen.

Harshit: Bro, can you send me yesterday's notes?

Akansh rolled his eyes.

"Of course," he muttered.

"One Sunday I decided to rest."

He stood up and began searching through the books and papers scattered across his desk. The mysterious box was taking up most of the space. Annoyed, he picked it up with his right hand to move it aside. His eyes fell on the strange red symbols one last time.

"What are you even made of, vibranium?" he asked with a small laugh. His right hand rested on the symbols. For a moment... something happened.

Then

Click.

Akansh froze. Slowly... very slowly... he looked down. The lid had shifted.

The box was open.

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At the exact moment the box opened... Something changed. Not on Earth. Not in the Solar System. But across and beyond the universe itself. An ancient signal that had slept in silence for countless years awakened once again. Far beyond Earth, beyond the Moon, beyond the reach of human eyes, on a lonely planet buried beneath endless snow and ice, an old man sat upon a cliff overlooking a frozen ocean. The cold wind howled across the white landscape. Snow fell endlessly from the dark sky above. Yet the old man remained perfectly still. Meditating. Waiting. Suddenly, his eyes opened. The wind around him stopped. For a brief moment, even the snow itself seemed to freeze in the air. The old man slowly stood up. For the first time in many years, worry appeared on his face.

"The Elements..." he whispered. His voice disappeared into the cold wind.

"It has been opened."

He turned his eyes toward the endless stars above him. After all these years... After all this waiting... It had finally happened. Without hesitation, he spoke into the empty air.

"ED." A faint blue light appeared beside him.

"Get ready." His expression hardened.

"We have to go now." Then

Thousands of light years away, near the edge of a dead world floating in the darkness of space, a ruined city stood beneath a sky without stars. At its center stood a black throne. Upon that throne sat a giant shadow. Motionless. Silent. Watching. The cold wind moved his long black cloak as he slowly lifted his head toward the sky. For a few moments, he said nothing. Then... A faint smile appeared on his face.

"So.. The Elements have finally chosen someone."

He slowly closed his eyes once more.

"The game has started." His laughter echoed through the empty city.

A deep, quiet laugh. Not of joy. But of anticipation. But

In another kingdom, beneath towers of silver and crystal, a man sat silently upon a golden throne while countless stars shone through the enormous windows behind him Suddenly...

He stood up. His expression changed instantly. "It can't be..."

For several moments, he simply stared into the distance. As if listening to something nobody else could hear. Then a small smile appeared on his face.

"So... You finally found him, old friend."

He looked toward the stars. And then...

Far beyond planets. Far beyond stars. Far beyond galaxies. Far beyond the universe itself.

There was only darkness. Endless darkness. Silence filled the void.

Then...

Two eyes slowly opened.

A presence older than worlds stirred within the shadows.

A voice echoed through the emptiness.

"Yes..."

A pause followed.

Then came the words that seemed to shake the darkness itself.

"Everything is going exactly as it should."

The eyes slowly closed once more.

The darkness returned.

And somewhere on a small blue planet called Earth...

A sixteen-year-old boy stared at an ancient box resting open in his hands.

Without knowing it...

The fate of the universe had just changed forever.

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